

EMEA Tuition Assistance Program – Automation Case Study

Overview

This project showcases the design and implementation of an **end-to-end employee tuition assistance workflow** using the Microsoft Power Platform. The solution replaces a manual, email-driven approval process with a **structured Power Apps form and an automated approval workflow**, ensuring consistency, auditability, and faster decision-making.

Note: Source code and workflow definitions are intentionally not shared due to enterprise confidentiality.

Problem Statement

Employees applied for tuition assistance via informal communication, resulting in:

- Inconsistent data capture
- Manual follow-ups with managers
- Lack of approval traceability
- Delayed communication to applicants
- No single source of truth

Solution Design

I designed a Power Platform–based solution consisting of:

1. Power Apps Application Form

A structured intake form that captures:

- Employee details (ID, role, office, business unit)
- Manager information
- Course and training details
- Mandatory acknowledgements and declarations

2. Automated Approval Workflow

Upon form submission:

- A manager approval request is triggered automatically
- The approval includes full context (course details, justification, cost)
- Manager comments are captured as part of the decision
- The application record is updated with the approval outcome
- Notifications are sent based on approval or rejection

End to End Workflow

Employee submits Power Apps form → Application stored in SharePoint → Manager approval request sent automatically → Approval decision captured with comments → Record updated for auditability → Applicant + stakeholders notified

Key Design Decisions

- **Form-driven intake** to eliminate free-text ambiguity
- **Manager-centric approval** for budget accountability
- **Single system of record** for traceability
- **Automated communication** to remove manual follow-ups
- **Decision transparency** via captured approval comments

Tech Stack

- Microsoft Power Apps (UI & data capture)
- Microsoft Power Automate (workflow orchestration)
- SharePoint Online (data persistence & audit trail)
- Microsoft Approvals & Outlook (decisioning & notifications)

Impact

- Reduced manual coordination effort
- Improved data consistency
- Faster approval turnaround
- Clear audit trail for HR/Learning teams
- Better experience for employees and managers

What this project demonstrates

- Business process automation
- Stakeholder-focused design
- Approval workflow modeling
- Enterprise-grade governance thinking
- End-to-end ownership (design → delivery)